

Apple acquires open source photonics startup invrs.io and hires its founder

Open source technology sits at the heart of Apple's latest acquisition. The company has purchased certain assets of invrs.io, a one-person startup known for developing open source frameworks for photonics research, and hired its sole employee and founder.

Invrs.io provides standardised simulation challenges, optimisation tools and a public benchmarking leaderboard, enabling researchers to test and compare optical designs. The move signals Apple's intent to internalise community-built, open research infrastructure to speed up hardware R&D.

The deal is structured as a micro-acquisition: Apple will acquire assets and bring on founder Martin Schubert, a former research scientist at Meta Platforms with more than a decade of experience across Google and Micron Technology, specialising in advanced display, chip and optical technologies.

Technically, invrs.io focuses on AI-guided design for optics and photonics, using simulation to model how light behaves in complex structures and optimise components faster. Such capabilities are directly relevant to cameras, displays, sensors and LiDAR systems that underpin Apple devices including the iPhone, iPad and Apple Vision Pro.



Earlier in February, Baidu AI Cloud introduced a Rapid Deployment Solution for OpenClaw using a visual configuration interface. DuClaw advances that effort by removing deployment altogether.

Shane Coughlan takes charge of OIN 2.0

Open Invention Network (OIN) has appointed Shane Coughlan as Global Ambassador for OIN 2.0, tasking the veteran open source leader with accelerating awareness, adoption and engagement around its next-generation open source patent protection framework.

OIN 2.0 introduces a modernised, community-driven model for safeguarding open source software (OSS). The framework adopts a tiered participation structure that preserves free access for individual developers and small businesses, while enabling broader shared investment from larger stakeholders to ensure long-term sustainability and expanded patent coverage for emerging technologies.

The move strengthens a global patent safety net for OSS, reducing litigation risk and reinforcing patent non-aggression as open source expands deeper into cloud, networking and AI.

Coughlan brings more than two decades of experience in open source governance and IP strategy. He most recently served as General Manager of the OpenChain Project at The Linux Foundation, building scalable compliance and supply-chain frameworks. He previously led OIN's licensing team during a major growth phase.

"Shane's unparalleled experience at the intersection of open source governance, intellectual property strategy and community advocacy makes him the ideal ambassador for this transformational phase of OIN," said Keith Bergelt, CEO of OIN. "As open source technologies continue to evolve and expand into new domains - cloud, networking, AI and beyond - Shane will help amplify OIN 2.0's mission and foster global participation to sustain and protect open source."

"In a world where open source innovation powers digital transformation across every industry, protecting that ecosystem from patent risk is fundamental," said Coughlan. "OIN 2.0 represents a shared commitment to the future of open technology."

Founded in 2005, OIN now counts over 4000 members and more than three million patents under cross-licence.

Linux Foundation's new initiative to accelerate Open RAN adoption

The Linux Foundation has announced the formation of the Open Centralized Unit Distributed Unit (OCUDU) Ecosystem Foundation, an open source initiative



designed to accelerate AI-enabled Open RAN innovation and reduce reliance on proprietary telecom infrastructure stacks.

Unveiled ahead of Mobile World Congress Barcelona, the initiative includes a working group and an open reference platform architecture

featuring AI algorithms and solution blueprints. The goal is to integrate artificial intelligence directly into radio access network (RAN) infrastructure while enabling scalable multi-vendor deployments.